"IN THE BEGINNING..."

GENESIS 24

IN 5 MINUTES

When:

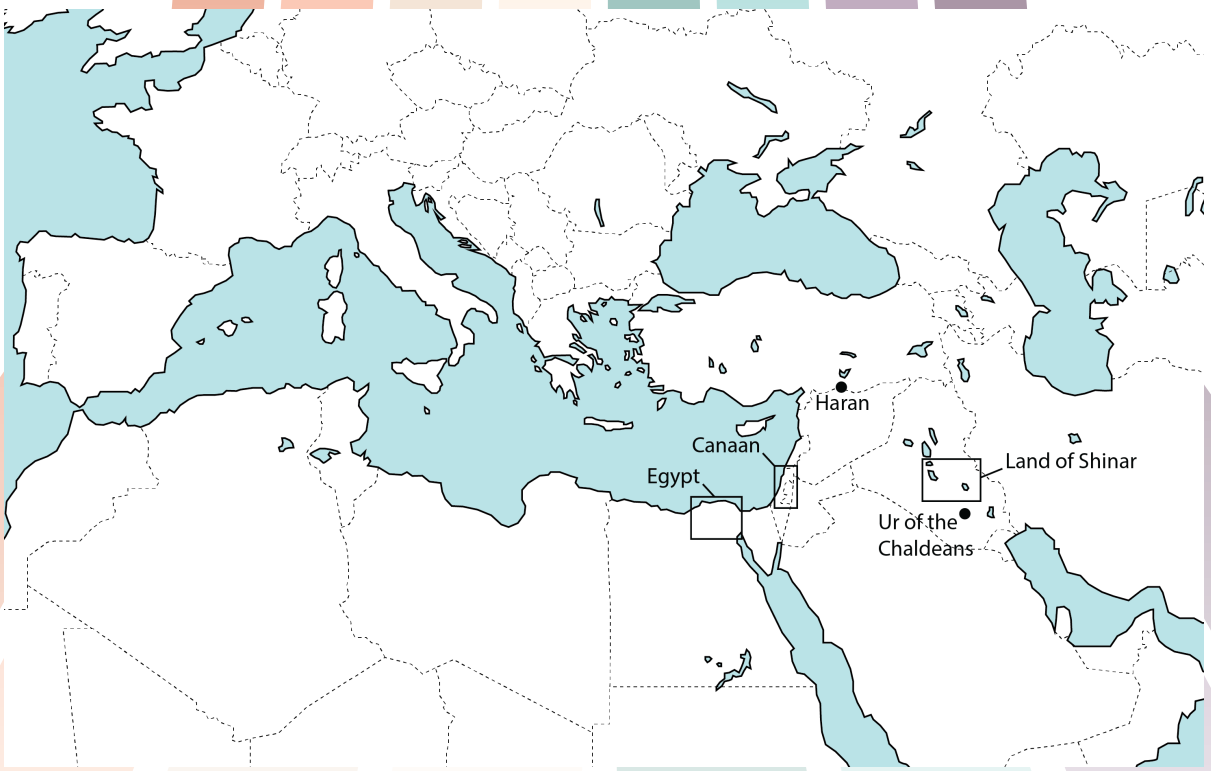
- Abram was born in approximately 1996 B.C. and died in 1821 B.C. at 175 years old (Gen 25:7). Isaac was born when Abraham was 100 years old (1896 B.C.), and was 37 years old when his mother, Sarah, died in approx. 1859 B.C. (Gen 23:1). According to Genesis 25:20, Isaac was 40 years old when he married Rebekah (1856 B.C.).

Characters:

- Abraham – A man from Ur of the Chaldeans who moved to Canaan at God's instruction. God promised to make his descendants a great nation and to give them the land of Canaan.
- Isaac – Abraham's son with Sarah.
- Abraham's Servant – The oldest servant in Abraham's house who he entrusted to find a wife for his son Isaac.
- Rebekah – A beautiful young woman who God chose to marry Isaac.
- Bethuel – The nephew of Abraham and father of Rebekah.

Where:

- Bethuel and Rebekah lived in Mesopotamia in the city of Nahor (Haran). Isaac lived in the Negeb south of Canaan.



Outline:

- ABRAHAM ASKS HIS SERVANT TO FIND ISAAC A WIFE (24:1-9):
    + Abraham was old and "well advanced in years."
    + He asked his most trusted servant to go to the city of Nahor, the land of his relatives, and find a wife for his son Isaac, because he didn't want him to marry a Canaanite.
    + The servant swore an oath to Abraham that he would do as he requested.
- THE SERVANT'S PRAYER FOR HELP (24:10-14):
    + The servant loaded 10 camels with provisions and gifts and went to "Mesopotamia to the city of Nahor" (approx. 550 miles away).
    + When he arrived, he prayed to God and asked Him to show him the right woman to marry Isaac.
    + While standing at a spring of water he prayed, "Let the young woman to whom I shall say, 'Please let down your jar that I may drink,' and who shall say, 'Drink, and I will water your camels'—let her be the one whom you have appointed for your servant Isaac."
- THE SERVANT MEETS REBEKAH AT THE SPRING OF WATER (24:15-27):
    + Before finishing his prayer, a beautiful young woman named Rebekah came to the spring for water.
    + The servant asked her for a drink, and she offered to water his camels.
    + Realizing his prayer had been answered the servant gave Rebekah gifts of gold.
    + Rebekah invited him to spend the night in her father Bethuel's house.
- THE SERVANT EXPLAINS HIS INTENTIONS TO BETHUEL (24:28-49):
    + Rebekah's brother Laban welcomed Abraham's servant and cared for his camels.
    + The servant recounted the details and purpose of his journey to Bethuel.
- REBEKAH LEAVES HER FATHER'S HOUSE (24:50-61):
    + Believing that God had blessed the servant's mission, Bethuel gave Rebekah permission to leave and marry Isaac.
    + When the servant heard this, he bowed and worshipped God.
    + The next morning, Rebekah and the servant began the journey back to Canaan.
- REBEKAH MARRIES ISAAC (24:62-67):
    + After their long journey, the servant found Isaac meditating in a field in the Negeb.
    + "Isaac brought her into the tent of Sarah his mother and took Rebekah, and she became his wife, and he loved her."

Application:

- Abraham's unnamed servant gives us a great example of a life permeated with prayer and worship.
- His first thought when arriving in Mesopotamia was to pray for God's help.
- His response to God answering his prayers was immediate worship (24:25-26; 52)
- Our lives should also be marked by a revolving pattern of prayer and worship.